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AQA · LEVEL 2 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 2

January 2022 - Reading Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) *Pass Mark Guide: ~65%*

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-Functional-Skills-English-Level-2-Reading-Jan-2022-QP

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

Verified by Tutor Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk

HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

Functional Skills Level 2
ENGLISH

Paper 1 Reading

Insert

The three sources that follow are:

Source A: a newspaper report
Source B: a leaflet for tenants
Source C: an extract from a podcast

Please open the Insert fully to see all three sources

Source A

Last Day in Paradise: How A Fire Swallowed A Town



On 8th November 2018, residents of Paradise in California awoke to a noxious orange atmosphere and chunks of burning wood falling from the sky.

Wildfires are a normal part of the forest ecosystem in California, and over the past decade parts of Paradise have been threatened by at least four fires. More than 200 structures were destroyed by fire in 2008.

Global warming has contributed to years of drought, leaving forests achingly dry and littered with dead trees. Fire experts call this vegetation 'fuel'.

Evacuations were ordered but the situation quickly spiralled into something far more terrifying. Soon the flames were being propelled downslope by gale-force winds. A blizzard of ash was falling from the sky as if from a volcano and coating the pine trees. Embers blown around by the extreme winds started a number of spot fires.

Paradise sits on a high ridge between two deep valleys and there is only one main route out of the town. As many of the inhabitants of Paradise all tried to leave at once, the result was gridlock. Cars, camper vans and trailers inched along as the fire outpaced them and trees and homes went up like torches. In the memory of one of the evacuees, everyone was composed and calm.

Outside it was growing dark, as if an eerie twilight were falling at 9 am. "Once I got outside, the smoke, the darkness – it looked like midnight," said Lynn Pitman, a school teacher evacuated along with her pupils. The winds were blowing plumes of smoke low over the town, forming a choking, swirling shroud about 1500 metres deep.

By now, the fire was raging from building to building. "It was panic," Firefighter Ken Lowe said, "pitch black, trees lighting up like matches all around, power lines arcing, embers skidding through the sky like amber snowflakes."

It took firefighters 17 days to bring the fire under control, by which time it had destroyed 14 000 homes, including almost 90% of those in Paradise, and 86 people had lost their lives.

Source B not reproduced here due to third-party copyright restrictions.

Source C

Professions Podcast

Presenter: Hello and welcome to the latest in our series of podcasts about careers. Today we're considering the role of firefighter with Head of Fire Service Recruitment, Jonas Carter.

Some people may picture a firefighter as a muscular bloke climbing down a ladder from a smoke-filled room with a helpless female over his shoulder.

Jonas: Frankly, that's nonsense. Today's firefighters are just as likely to be female themselves. And there's far more to the job than rescuing people from burning buildings.

Presenter: Such as?

Jonas: Clearly the main role is responding to and extinguishing fires. But you may also be required to deal with chemical spillages and Road Traffic Collisions which might involve using cutting equipment to free a trapped driver or passenger.

Presenter: That all sounds very exciting but dangerous too. What makes a good firefighter?

Jonas: We need people who are confident, have good problem-solving skills and are able to use their initiative. Obviously there is extensive training, but it's important to start with the right raw material. Firefighters also need to be versatile as the role is very varied.

Presenter: In what way?

Jonas: As well as putting out fires, we work closely in the community to help prevent fires happening in the first place. We do this by visiting people in their own homes to educate them in fire prevention including advice on such things as smoke alarms. If a fire does break out, it's important that people have an escape route: we can assist with identifying and planning this. We also train fire wardens in schools, community centres and libraries.

Presenter: Thanks for now. Join us after the break to find out how to apply.

END OF SOURCES

There are no sources printed on this page

Open out this page to see
Source B and Source C

There are no sources printed on this page

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2 2 1 A 8 7 2 5 R

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1** to **6**.

0 1 What is the **full** name of the teacher mentioned in **Source A**?

[1 mark]

Lynne/ Lynn Pitman Pitman

0 2 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source A states: '…residents of Paradise in California awoke to a noxious orange atmosphere'.

In this quotation, the word 'noxious' means

A innocuous.
B poisonous.
C thick.
D horrible.

B poisonous 3.1.15

[1 mark] Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

0 3 The report implies that

A people panicking caused more deaths.
B the firefighters were not good at their jobs.
C the town should have been built in a different place.
D it was almost impossible to prevent this wildfire.

Write the correct letter in the box.

D it was almost impossible to prevent this wildfire. 3.1.13

Answer

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

Question 1 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

. .

Mrs/Ms/Miss Lynne Pitman Lynne (alone)

· Mrs/Ms/Miss Lynne

[1 mark]

Do not write outside the box

0 4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
More than 200 homes were destroyed in 2008.		
The fire was moving more quickly than the traffic.		
Paradise has had at least four fires in the past ten years.		
The wildfire caused a volcano to erupt.		

More than 200 homes were destroyed in 2008. ☐
☐
The fire was moving more quickly than the traffic.
Paradise has had at least four fires in the past ten years. ☐
☐

[2 marks]

0 5 The writer of **Source A** presents both facts and opinions.

0 5 . 1 Identify **two** facts about the town of Paradise, apart from its fires.

Fact 1 _____

• It's •
in California. Accept the whole of It had a fire in 2018.
the first sentence.
•

Fact 2 _____

Many people died there
•
Only one main route into / out of the
town.
[1 mark]

[1 mark]

0 5 . 2 Identify **two** opinions about the 2018 wildfire in Paradise.

Opinion 1 _____

_____

Opinion 2 _____

_____

[1 mark]

Question 5 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

The writer of Source A presents both facts and opinions.
[1 mark]

Question 4 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

The wildfire caused a volcano to erupt.

2 marks for all four correct

1 mark for three correct

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

0 6 Explain how the writer of **Source A** uses words and language techniques to **describe** the wildfire.

You should provide examples from **Source A** in your answer.

[3 marks]

Not acceptable as relevant material for a describe task 0 marks
The writer uses lots of facts and statistics like "It took firefighters 17 days to bring the fire under control. This shows how big the fire was and what a difficult job the firefighters had.
–
Factual/statistical information plus a comment 1 mark
The writer uses a headline reading "Fire swallowed a town" to grab the attention of the reader.
Generic effect, therefore not an attempt; identification of relevant material = 1 mark
[0 marks]

10

Do not write outside the box

Section B

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7** to **11**.

0 7 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source B states: '…you could become disorientated'.

In this quotation, the word 'disorientated' means

A unwell.
B scared.
C dizzy.
D confused.

Write the correct letter in the box.

D confused. 3.1.15
[1 mark]

Answer

[1 mark]

0 8 According to **Source B**,

A smoke alarms are a legal requirement in homes.
B gas appliances must be checked by the landlord.
C electrical safety checks will prevent all fires.
D window keys should be hidden safely.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer

[1 mark]

Turn over for the next question

Do not write outside the box

0 9 Using the information in **Source B**, put a tick (✓) in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
Fires are more common in rented accommodation.		
Landlords must supply furniture.		
The UK has 3000 deaths per year from fires in the home.		
Gas Safe engineers should supply safety certificates.		

Fires are more common in rented accommodation. □
□
Landlords must supply furniture.
□
The UK has 3000 deaths per year from fires in the home.
Gas Safe engineers should supply safety certificates. □

[2 marks]

1 0 From **Source B**, list **three** questions a tenant should ask the landlord to check that they have met their legal obligations.

[3 marks]

1 CHECKING/REGISTERED ENGINEER Precise lifts of relevant information eg

Gas appliances must carry a safety

2 Have the gas appliances been

certificate = 0 marks Do the gas

3 checked by a registered engineer? //

appliances have a safety certificate? =

[3 marks]

1 1 From **Source B**, list **three** important actions to make sure you can escape safely if a fire occurs.

[3 marks]

1 Indicative content

Answers may mention the following:

2 Plan your escape route (and make Your landlord should ensure that there

sure everyone ~~knows it) // Make sure is a safe exit.~~

3 everyone knows the escape route.

· Go out of ~~the safe / fire exit~~

[3 marks]

10

Question 9 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

2 marks for all four correct
1 mark for three correct
[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

Section C

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12** and **13**.

You will need to use both **Source A** and **Source C** to answer **Question 14**.

12 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question.

Source C states: 'Firefighters also need to be versatile…'

In this quotation, the word 'versatile' means

A strong.
B adaptable.
C clever.
D careful.

Write the correct letter in the box.

Answer [ ]

[1 mark]

13 A firefighter's main job is to put out fires. From **Source C**, list **three other** tasks a firefighter might do.

[3 marks]

1 Deal with / attend chemical spillages Put out fires

2 Deal with / attend road traffic
· Use cutting ~~equipment (alone)~~

3 accidents (including using cutting equipment) ~~// Freeing trapped drivers /~~

[3 marks]

Do not write outside the box

1 4 Compare **Source A** and **Source C** in terms of what they say and how the material is conveyed.

You may wish to refer to the level of detail, presentation and language, formality, possible bias and how the writers come across.

[6 marks]

A range of similarities/differences are identified and explained in detail, such as:
· level of detail in text (main points/specific details)
·
the information, ideas or opinions and how these are conveyed, including text type
5–6 style of writing/writer's voice/tone/level of formality/potential bias marks ·
·
[6 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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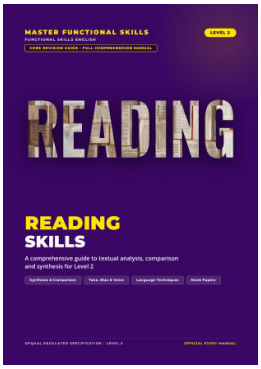
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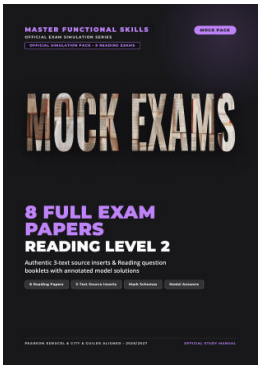


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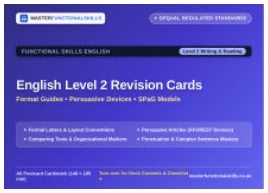


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